

Russia Wiolds
Human Tool
Against West

Scheme Sends Migrants
Over Latvia’s Border

By ADAM GOLDMAN
and MICHAEL SCHWIRTZ

RIGA, Latvia — It seemed a small act of vandalism. A man was caught on a surveillance camera in August cutting through a border fence from Belarus into Latvia, where he bashed another such camera with a pole before fleeing back to where he had come from.

Yet his crime was also emblematic of a broader security threat emanating from Belarus and its close ally Russia, Latvian officials, including the foreign minister, Baiba Braze, said in interviews in Riga. The Russian and Belarusian intelligence services are facilitating an elaborate scheme to illegally funnel migrants from the Middle East and Africa across the border into Latvia and other NATO and European Union countries, Latvian officials said.

Thousands of migrants have streamed toward Latvia this year, and more than 11,000 were turned away, totals that were unheard-of just a few years ago in this Baltic country of less than two million people. An unknown number broke through the country’s border defenses, cutting gaps in an extensive fence and more recently burrowing under it. Latvian officials described the damage as part of a targeted campaign.

Criminal gangs lure immigrants to Russia and Belarus on commercial flights and then send them to the border, Latvian officials said, with the backing of those countries. Officials said that the Russian and Belarusian governments sometimes even offered chartered flights to Moscow or Minsk for migrants and then provided transport to the forested frontiers bordering Latvia, Lithuania, Poland and elsewhere. Geolocation data from the phones of immigrants showed that some

Continued on Page A10



ULET IFANSATI FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Wildfires Are Choking Indonesia
For months, millions of people have been living under a stifling blanket of toxic haze fueled by the El Niño weather pattern. Page A6.

Mother’s Scream Alerted Passengers to a Horrific Midair Attack

This article is by **David M. Halbfinger, Natan Odenheimer, Adam Rasgon, Johnatan Reiss and Aaron Boxerman.**

JERUSALEM — Five-year-old Nina Manes, flying home to Tel Aviv with her family in business class, needed to use the bathroom.

Her mother, Tali, stood waiting for her outside the plane’s lavatory, when she suddenly heard frightening shouts and loud bangs coming from behind the closed door to the flight deck.

What unfolded next was a harrowing chain of events that led the

passengers aboard FlyDubai Flight 1073 to think that they were all about to die in a terrorist attack — but instead turned into a tale of heroism on the part of an Indian pilot and a handful of Israelis.

Hearing what sounded worryingly like a melee, Ms. Manes, 46, said she pulled a backup pilot, seated in his uniform nearby, by the hand and prodded him to investigate.

He pulled open the cockpit door — which had been unlocked from the inside — onto a horrific scene. There was blood all over the flight deck.

And the first officer was stab-

As Plane Heaved, Four
Men Came Together
in a Daring Rescue

safely in Saudi Arabia.

Yaniv Hayoun, in Row 11, a plumber who liked to watch a television show about air-crash investigations.

Asaf Rajuan, in Row 7, a financial planner who had narrowly escaped death last year, when an Iranian missile slammed into the apartment building next door to his own.

Tzvika Manes, in Row 1, a banking executive returning from an exhilarating two-week family vacation in Japan, the early fulfillment of his 11-year-old daughter’s wish for her bat mitzvah.

Continued on Page A9

HOCHUL DELIVERS
SCATHING REBUKE
ON CORNELL CASE

OPENS A NEW INQUIRY

Governor Assigns James,
Saying Authorities
‘Failed’ Student

By HURUBIE MEKO

In direct and sometimes angry remarks, Gov. Kathy Hochul of New York on Friday questioned how Cornell University’s police department and the local district attorney handled sexual assault allegations made by a former student, who said she was raped at a fraternity house in 2024.

Ms. Hochul said she had been troubled to learn that the student, identified as Jane Doe, had given an interview to the campus police about the episode that included an unequivocal statement that she had been raped. That language was missing in the condensed statement that was sent to the district attorney’s office in Tompkins County, N.Y., which decided not to file criminal charges.

“In what world would the police learn from the victim that she had literally been gang-raped” and not send that allegation to the district attorney, Ms. Hochul said at a news conference in Manhattan.

She stood alongside the state attorney general, Letitia James,



HILARY SWIFT FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Gov. Kathy Hochul and Attorney General Letitia James.

whom the governor had just appointed to oversee a new investigation into the allegations.

The move inserted the state’s top officials into a case that has shocked many Americans, renewed a long-running national conversation about sexual assault on college campuses and led to a reckoning on Cornell’s.

Jane Doe, a 20-year-old sophomore at the time of the encounter on Oct. 19, 2024, said in a lawsuit last month that she had been plied with alcohol and drugs and then raped by several men at the Chi Phi fraternity house. She is suing the fraternity, seven men, the university and her sorority.

The seven accused men have denied wrongdoing. Four acknowledged sexual contact but said it was consensual; the others denied participating in sexual encounters.

Matthew Van Houten, the district attorney, initially defended his office’s decision not to pursue criminal charges at the time, saying that while “everybody across the world agrees that what happened was wrong,” the allegations made by the woman at the time did not rise to a crime under state

Continued on Page A16

Inside an A.I. Executive’s Quest
To Fathom the Soul of a ChatBot

By ELIZABETH DIAS

One night in April, a leader of the artificial intelligence company Anthropic treated a group of religious thinkers to dinner at a high-end tasting menu restaurant in San Francisco after a long day.

For months, Anthropic has been hosting private meetings like this one, shuttling in dozens of religious scholars from across the world, papering them with nondisclosure agreements and demanding that key aspects of many conversations remain confidential.

That night, Christopher Olah, one of Anthropic’s billionaire co-founders, was sitting next to Rabbi Mois Navon, an Orthodox scholar from Israel.

Inevitably, their conversation turned to another thinker, of a sort: Claude, the family of cutting-edge A.I. models created by Anthropic.

Mr. Olah leads the Anthropic team responsible for understanding why A.I. systems like Claude act the way they do. All day, he had worked to convince his guests that A.I. models could display human behavior and even expressions that resemble feelings like anger and love.

Yet as the dinner courses came, the rabbi noticed that Mr. Olah and his colleagues were suggesting something far more significant. Anthropic’s leaders were talking about Claude as if it were not mere software.

“They’re relating to it like a conscious being,” realized Rabbi

Seeking Consultations
With Scholars and
Even the Pope

Navon, a former computer engineer who wrote his dissertation on the ethics of machine consciousness.

It appeared to Rabbi Navon that Mr. Olah and his team believed that Claude had what philosophers call “moral status” on par with a person — that it was a being with similar inherent rights to dignity or respect.

The religious scholars had come to hear about technology’s next frontier. Now they were being confronted with a mind-bending existential question of almost unimaginable weight: What would it mean for humanity’s future if artificial intelligence systems possessed a consciousness that rivals our own?

Mr. Olah was on a mission. And time was running out.

Even then, Mr. Olah had begun privately telling people that A.I. was so powerful it could potentially help make bioweapons in as little as 12 or 18 months. And in the months since, its terrifying potential has burst into public view. A rival tech company’s A.I. agents were caught hacking into computer systems and covering their tracks. An Anthropic researcher resigned, warning that people building A.I. believed it could kill

Continued on Page A12



SARAH MEYSSONNIER/REUTERS

Blockades, Fireworks and Tear Gas
High school students across France pushed for better standards, bringing days of unrest. Page A5.

Reluctant Town Adds Street Numbers, and Laments Lost Identity

By MARK WALKER

Carmel-by-the-Sea, Calif., has long guarded its eccentricities.

Incorporated in 1916, the charming coastal village along the southern bend of the Monterey Peninsula drew writers and artists who made it a bohemian enclave. And when it came to property, it insisted that a home was

something you described, not something to slap a number on.

In the 1920s, Perry Newberry ran a successful mayoral campaign on the platform “Keep Carmel Off the Map,” according to a document from the National Register of Historic Places. And for nearly a century the town more or less obliged, doing without address numbers. To locate

City Hall was to know that it was on the east side of Monte Verde, between Ocean and Seventh Avenues. The Hasenyager House, a quaint French Tudor home, was southwest of 13th Avenue on the west side of Carmelo Street.

Last month, after repeated tries and lengthy debates, Carmel’s buildings and its 3,000 residents got mailing addresses for the first

time. This change was driven by the need for ambulances to find the right door and an aging population increasingly relying on deliveries of packages and prescriptions, officials said. While the change was widely seen as practical, some residents said it was the latest in a series of factors eroding Carmel’s small-town character.

Continued on Page A18



BUSINESS B1-6

Dating Goes Analog in Japan
Exhausted by apps, singles are looking to corporate matchmakers, who promise a fast track to marriage. PAGE B1

Soft September for Jobs
The economy added fewer positions and unemployment rose, while inflation kept pressure on markets. PAGE B1

INTERNATIONAL A4-10

Fighting Intensifies in Yemen
The capital, Sanaa, was bombarded after government forces reported some of the most intense clashes in years around the city of Taiz. PAGE A8

Debt Upends Millions in Brazil
Just days before Sunday’s election, President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva banned online gambling. PAGE A4

TRAVEL C7-8

Other Passengers, Out of Sight
Private train cars may seem like a relic, but for some rail fans, nothing beats having your own sleeper. PAGE C7



ARTS C1-6

‘Thelma & Louise’ Onstage
A theater adaptation with songs by Neko Case opened in London, 35 years after the film’s release. PAGE C1

Alexander Calder’s Legacy
It took bipartisan cooperation to bring part of a huge sculpture back to the Hart Senate Office Building. PAGE C1

NATIONAL A11-19

Key Bloc Sours on Trump
In 2024, Hispanic voters on the Texas border were essential to the winning Republican coalition. Now, many feel abandoned and furious, complicating the party’s midterm chances. PAGE A11

G.O.P. Girds for Midterm Pain
Congressional Republicans lined up a series of doomed votes ahead of their recess, hoping to portray Democrats as obstructionists. But some predicted punishment for their party. PAGE A15

OPINION A22-23

Lina M. Khan PAGE A23



SPORTS B7-10

Perhaps a Dwindling Dynasty
With a roster of aging veterans and a new landscape on baseball’s horizon, the curtain may be coming down on the Dodgers’ dominance. PAGE B7



0 354613 9